

IT Resume Standards for New Zealand ¹ and Australia ²

Executive summary

For non-academic IT hiring in NZ/AU, the expected document is a concise, job-targeted resume/CV rather than a full academic CV. The strongest cross-source consensus is this: keep the document simple, easy to scan, and tailored to the job ad; use one page when you are a recent graduate or have only a small amount of directly relevant experience; use two pages when you have enough genuinely relevant work or project evidence to justify the space. NZ official guidance says to keep a CV to two pages if possible; major AU/NZ job-board and recruiter guidance converges on one page for recent graduates and one to two pages overall. ³

For ATS parsing, the most defensible NZ/AU default is a single-column layout with standard headings, standard fonts, real text rather than image-based content, and no tables, text boxes, graphics, or photos. The best-supported heading set is Contact Information, Summary, Work Experience, Education, Skills, and Certifications/Training. The strongest evidence also supports .docx as the safest ATS format, with text-based PDF acceptable where the employer allows it. ⁴

For junior IT roles, section priority is not symmetrical. If you have any real-world experience, put Work Experience above Projects. If you do not, elevate substantial projects and open-source work, but keep the structure stable and employer-readable. Software hiring-manager guidance gives the strongest order-of-importance rule: internships and real-world work first, then meaningful project contributions, then education, then smaller projects and extras; local NZ/AU guidance reinforces reverse-chronological work history, relevant skills, and targeted project inclusion. ⁵

The most practical strategy is to maintain two versions of the same resume: an ATS-safe application copy for portals, recruiters, and large employers, and a lightly designed portfolio copy for networking, direct outreach, interviews, and follow-up. The portfolio copy should not replace the ATS copy; in NZ/AU, the CV/resume remains the standard application document, while proof-of-work and online project visibility strengthen it. ⁶

Because no employer, sector niche, or exact experience band was specified, this report assumes broad commercial IT hiring rather than academic hiring or public-sector applications that require separate selection-criteria responses. I interpret Graduate/Junior as roughly 0–2 years of relevant experience and Junior-Mid as roughly 2–4 years.

Evidence base and market conventions

The source hierarchy for this report was weighted deliberately: official career guidance first, then major job boards, then major recruitment firms, then software-employer/platform guidance. The practical finding is that NZ and AU guidance is more similar than different: both markets want short, tailored, relevant resumes/CVs, and both now place heavy emphasis on readability, keywords, and clean structure. ⁷

Terminology varies, but the underlying document type does not vary much for IT roles. NZ official guidance says a CV is “sometimes called a resume”; Australian government guidance says both terms are used in Australia; recruiter guidance still notes that “CV” is the more locally typical term in Australia and New Zealand, even though job boards often write “resume” or “résumé”. In practice, for IT jobs outside academia, what matters is not the label but that the document is short, tailored, and role-specific. Use whichever term the job ad uses. ⁸

NZ official guidance makes a useful distinction between a skills-focused CV and a work-focused CV. The skills-focused version is aimed at people with no work experience or with gaps; the work-focused version is aimed at people with work experience or those moving to the next stage of their career. Australian official and job-board guidance expresses the same idea through chronological, functional, and combination formats. For junior IT applicants, that means the “best” format is not universal: it depends mostly on how much credible work history you already have. ⁹

The largest market differences are minor rather than structural. NZ official guidance is slightly more explicit about referees and about keeping the document short; Australian government guidance is somewhat looser on page count in the abstract, but AU job-board and recruiter guidance tightens back down to one or two pages for modern hiring. Australia-specific guidance is also more explicit about omitting personal demographic details and photos, while NZ official guidance reaches almost the same result by insisting on a simple CV with no images and only the most relevant information. ¹⁰

Public-sector hiring is the main exception worth noting. Australian government guidance points out that some roles, especially government roles, may require separate selection-criteria responses; those should not be crammed into the resume itself. The resume remains a modular overview, while the criteria response is a separate document. ¹¹

Market comparison

Aspect	NZ pattern	AU pattern	Practical takeaway for junior IT
Local term	“CV” dominates in official guidance	“Resume” and “CV” both used	Match the job ad’s wording
Normal non-academic length	Keep to 2 pages if possible	1–2 pages in modern recruiter/job-board guidance	1 page for thin experience; 2 pages only when justified
Default structure	Skills-focused or work-focused	Chronological, functional, or combination	Combination is often best for junior IT
Referees	Include only if asked; otherwise “available on request”	Similar recruiter norm	Keep referee details off the main document unless asked
ATS expectations	Simple, text-based, standard headings	Same	Build for parsers and humans at once

The table above is a synthesis of the official and recruiter guidance rather than a verbatim rule set. The strongest consensus for modern NZ/AU IT hiring is the practical one in the last column. ¹²

ATS and parsing implications

The most important nuance is that ATS matters, but ATS mythology is also a problem. Local NZ/AU job-board and recruiter guidance consistently advises keyword matching, standard headings, simple formatting, and accepted file formats because many employers do parse applications automatically. At the same time, software hiring-manager guidance argues that the decisive read is still human and warns against writing for an imaginary robot at the expense of clarity. The best interpretation is not “ignore ATS” or “optimise only for ATS”; it is “make parsing easy, then make the human scan excellent.”

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A clean single-column format is the strongest default for NZ/AU IT resumes. SEEK’s NZ and AU ATS guidance explicitly recommends single-column layouts and says columns, text boxes, tables, and graphics can cause text to be read out of order or missed entirely. Indeed Australia likewise says ATS systems often struggle with complex displays such as columns, tables, and charts. A software hiring-manager perspective comes to the same conclusion from the human side: single-column reading is easier top-to-bottom and makes dates, job titles, locations, and technologies easier to scan in seconds.

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Font guidance is unusually consistent across the source set. NZ official guidance recommends a plain black font such as Calibri 11. SEEK recommends Arial, Times New Roman, or Calibri. Hays recommends simple fonts such as Arial or Calibri at 10 or 12 point. Indeed Australia recommends 10–12 point type and a professional readable font. This is one of the clearest areas of convergence in the research.

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The summary should be short, but not absent by default. SEEK’s current guidance says a summary should usually be one to three sentences; Hays NZ suggests roughly 50–150 words for IT resumes. The most practical synthesis for junior IT candidates is 35–80 words: enough to state role fit, core stack, and one value proposition, but not long enough to displace evidence.

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Standard headings are not optional in the ATS-safe version. NZ and AU SEEK guidance explicitly recommends standard section names and lists the most useful ones: Contact Information, Summary, Work Experience, Education, Skills, and Certifications/Training. Indeed Australia adds that headings help the ATS process information correctly and may also help keyword matching when employers use organisation-specific terms.

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File-format guidance needs a balanced reading. SEEK says the most commonly accepted formats are .docx and .pdf, but warns that PDFs must not be image-based and says .docx is often the safest choice. Hays Australia says accepted formats such as .doc or .pdf are important because alternative styles may not parse correctly. The most defensible operational rule for NZ/AU IT applications is therefore: keep a master in DOCX, export a text-based PDF for human-read copies, and always obey the portal instructions if it specifies the file type.

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Photos, icons, heavy graphic devices, and decorative sidebars are risky in the ATS version. Australia-specific guidance explicitly says not to include a photo unless requested, and NZ official guidance says not to use images. Since ATS guidance repeatedly says to avoid graphics and keep the document text-based, icons in contact sections belong in the portfolio copy only, not in the ATS copy. There is no strong NZ/AU primary-source rule on exact colour use, so the safest inference is restrained or no colour in the ATS version and only minimal accent colour in the portfolio version.

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Work-experience bullets should be brief, specific, and evidence-led. SEEK’s space guidance recommends 3–7 bullets per role and a maximum of two lines per bullet; Hays advises highlighting the most relevant

responsibilities and successes; Michael Page recommends result-first bullet construction; and multiple recruiter sources emphasise quantifiable achievements rather than mere duty lists. For junior resumes, that translates into 2–4 bullets for the most recent role, 2–3 for earlier relevant roles, and fewer if the role is old or peripheral. ²⁰

No primary source in this research set gave hard rules for exact line-spacing values, exact margin widths beyond general readability advice, or paper size. The safest defaults are therefore conservative ones: about 0.75–1 inch margins, balanced spacing that looks neither sparse nor cramped, and a standard A4 export for NZ/AU use unless a portal reflows the document anyway. Indeed Australia explicitly gives one-inch margins as a sound formatting starting point. ²¹

ATS-safe formatting rules

Element	Recommended default for NZ/AU junior IT resumes
Layout	Single column only
Fonts	Arial, Calibri, or Times New Roman
Font size	10–12 pt body; headings modestly larger
Colour	Black or very dark grey text; no heavy colour dependence
Graphics	No photos, icons, charts, sidebars, text boxes, or tables in ATS copy
Headings	Contact Information, Summary, Work Experience, Education, Skills, Certifications/ Training
File type	DOCX safest; text-based PDF acceptable if allowed
Dates	Month YYYY – Month YYYY
Bullet density	2–4 bullets for recent roles; 3–7 maximum; two lines max each
References	“Referees available on request” unless the ad asks for names/details

These defaults are synthesised directly from the local guidance on fonts, headings, file formats, ATS readability, and resume brevity. ²²

Modular resume architecture

The right modular structure depends mostly on whether your evidence base is work-led or project-led. NZ official guidance frames this as skills-focused versus work-focused. Australian guidance frames it as chronological, functional, or combination. For junior IT hiring, the best default is usually a combination structure: enough room to show technology stack and projects, but still anchored in reverse-chronological work experience wherever you have it. Purely functional resumes are harder to trust unless there is a good reason, such as substantial gaps or almost no relevant work history. ²³

The strongest section-order rule for software resumes is still relevance first. For new graduates and bootcamp-style candidates, software hiring guidance places real-world experience and open-source contributions above smaller personal projects. Local recruiter/job-board guidance adds that recent graduates can legitimately include relevant coursework, academic achievements, and projects in

education or additional-information space. The resulting NZ/AU structure should therefore shift only when evidence is thin, not because a template looks fashionable. ²⁴

Recommended section order by experience band

Candidate profile	Best default structure	Page target	Format bias
Graduate with no relevant paid experience	Contact → Summary → Technical Skills → Selected Projects / Open Source → Education → Other Experience → Certifications	1 page	Combination or skills-focused
Graduate with internship / placement / freelance evidence	Contact → Summary → Technical Skills → Work Experience → Selected Projects → Education → Certifications	1 page, sometimes 2	Combination leaning work-focused
Junior with 1–2 years relevant experience	Contact → Summary → Technical Skills → Work Experience → Selected Projects → Education → Certifications	1–2 pages	Reverse-chronological or combination
Junior-Mid with 2–4 years relevant experience	Contact → Summary → Technical Skills → Work Experience → Selected Projects / Open Source → Education → Certifications	2 pages	Reverse-chronological

This ordering reflects the overlap between local ATS-safe module expectations and software-hiring-manager reading order. ²⁵

Work Experience should usually outrank Projects. If a project was built inside a paid role, it should normally live under that role rather than be duplicated in a separate Projects section. The exception is when the project has independent value as a public artefact, open-source contribution, published product, or standout demo. The underlying principle is the same across the evidence base: relevance and proof beat volume. ²⁶

A good junior IT resume also needs a disciplined way to classify projects. The A/B/C model below is a synthesis from the evidence: recruiter guidance says keep only what is relevant; software-hiring guidance values real-world work and standout projects; Hays advises juniors to include strong personal or school projects when experience is light. ²⁷

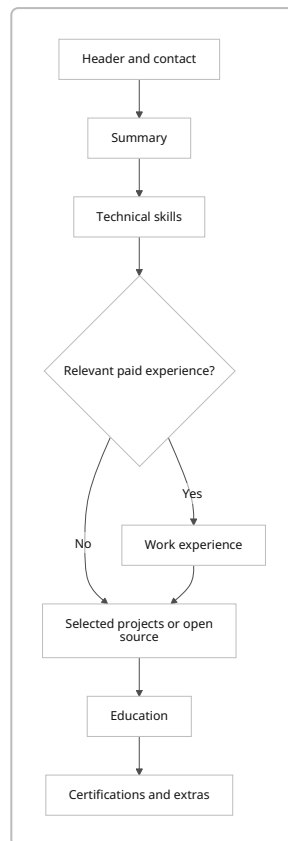
Project classification model

Tier	What belongs here	Where it goes	Length rule	Example
A projects	Live commercial work, major internship deliverables, open-source contributions with merged PRs, deployed apps with real users, meaningful production-like systems	Near Work Experience or top of Projects	2–4 bullets	“Built authentication and billing API used by 3 internal teams”
B projects	Strong capstones, team projects, hackathon winners, well-documented deployed apps, high-quality personal systems with tests/CI/docs	Selected Projects	1–3 bullets	“Deployed full-stack booking platform with CI, tests, and role-based access”
C projects	Tutorial clones, short coursework, repetitive CRUD demos, old unrelated experiments	Usually omit from main resume; keep on code profile only	0–1 line or omit	“Weather app tutorial clone”

The rule is simple: A projects compete with work experience, B projects support it, and C projects rarely deserve page space in a junior IT application. ²⁸

Layout models and visuals

The flow below reflects the strongest general-case architecture for a junior IT resume that has at least some real-world evidence. If you have no relevant paid work, swap Work Experience and Selected Projects, but keep the rest of the module order stable. ²⁹



No primary source in this set prescribes exact per-section word counts, so the layout budgets below translate page-limit and readability guidance into practical module budgets for junior IT roles. They are intended as working targets, not rigid law. ³⁰

One-page compressed layout

Section	Target lines	Approx. words	Bullet count	Notes
Header and contact	2-3	12-24	0	Name, city, phone, email, portfolio/ profile links
Summary	2-3	35-60	0	One role-fit statement, one stack statement, one value statement
Technical skills	4-6	20-45 terms	0	Group into 4-6 categories
Work experience	8-12	70-130	2-4 total per role	One strong role or two very compressed roles
Selected projects	8-12	80-150	2-4 total	One to two projects only
Education	2-4	15-35	0-1	Degree plus key detail only
Certifications / extras	1-2	6-18	0-1	Only if genuinely valuable

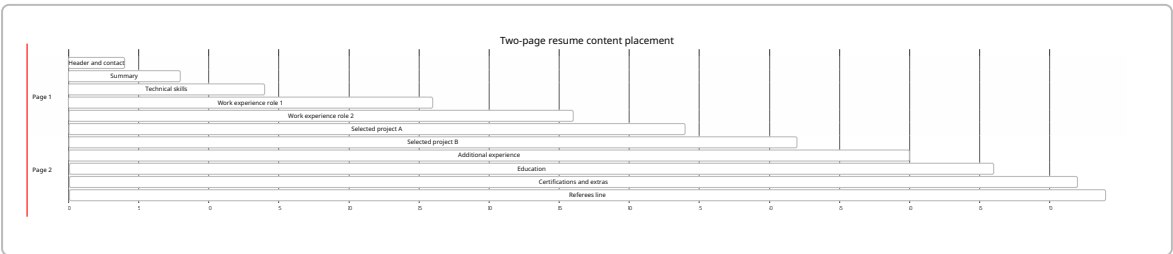
This layout is best when you have one internship or less, one or two standout projects, and no need to explain a long work history. It matches the repeated local recommendation that recent graduates and early-career candidates should aim for a short document with only the most relevant material. ³¹

Two-page skeleton layout

Section	Target lines	Approx. words	Bullet count	Placement
Header and contact	2-3	12-24	0	Page 1 top
Summary	2-4	45-80	0	Page 1 top
Technical skills	5-7	25-55 terms	0	Page 1 top
Work experience role 1	8-12	90-160	3-4	Page 1 core
Work experience role 2	7-10	70-140	2-4	Page 1 core
Selected project A	5-8	55-110	2-3	Page 1 bottom or Page 2 top
Selected project B	5-8	55-110	2-3	Page 2 top
Additional experience / project C	4-7	40-90	1-2	Page 2 middle
Education	3-5	20-45	0-1	Page 2 lower
Certifications / awards / open source	2-5	12-40	0-2	Page 2 lower
Referees line	1	3-6	0	Page 2 bottom

A two-page junior IT resume is justified when you have multiple relevant internships, contract roles, major projects, or a hybrid software-plus-AI profile that would be weakened by aggressive compression. The research strongly supports two pages when the second page contains relevant evidence rather than filler. ³²

The placement timeline below shows a practical way to allocate document space without allowing lower-value content to crowd out the first page. ³³



Template examples and bullet banks

The templates below are structured to fit the NZ/AU norms established above: short summary, grouped technical skills, reverse-chronological evidence where available, and tightly edited projects. They are examples and editable scaffolds, not model answers to copy unchanged. ³⁴

Full Stack Junior template

YOUR NAME

City, Country | Phone | Email | Portfolio | Code Profile

SUMMARY

Junior Full Stack Developer with hands-on experience building web applications with React, TypeScript, Node.js / ASP.NET Core, and PostgreSQL. Comfortable delivering frontend features, backend APIs, testing, and containerised deployments. Looking to contribute to a product team shipping reliable user-facing software.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: TypeScript, JavaScript, C#, SQL, Python

Frontend: React, Next.js, HTML, CSS, Tailwind

Backend: ASP.NET Core, Node.js, REST APIs

Databases: PostgreSQL, MySQL, Redis

DevOps & Cloud: Docker, GitHub Actions, AWS / Azure

Testing & Tools: Jest, Playwright, Postman, Git

WORK EXPERIENCE

Software Developer Intern | Company Name | Month YYYY – Month YYYY

- Built [feature/module] in React and TypeScript for [workflow or product area], reducing [manual steps / turnaround time] by [X% or X hours].
- Developed [REST API / service] in [Node.js / ASP.NET Core] to support [business function], handling [volume/users] and improving [speed / reliability].
- Added [tests / CI pipeline / deployment automation], increasing release confidence and reducing [defects / manual deployment time].
- Collaborated with [designer / product manager / QA / senior engineers] to scope, implement, and ship [feature] within [sprint / deadline].

SELECTED PROJECTS

Project Name | React, TypeScript, PostgreSQL, Docker

- Built [what the system does] for [target users], including [two or three core modules].
- Designed [database / API / auth / deployment pipeline] using [tools], supporting [key non-trivial requirement].
- Improved [metric] by [X] through [specific optimisation, caching, validation, testing, or UI redesign].

Project Name | Next.js, Node.js, Redis, GitHub Actions

- Implemented [user flow or backend capability] with [technical approach].
- Deployed the application with [Docker / cloud platform / CI], enabling [faster release cycle / stable environment / automated testing].

EDUCATION

Bachelor / Master of [Degree]

Institution Name | City | Expected YYYY / YYYY

CERTIFICATIONS

AWS Cloud Practitioner | YYYY
Azure Fundamentals | YYYY

OPTIONAL

Referees available on request

AI Junior template

YOUR NAME

City, Country | Phone | Email | Portfolio | Code Profile

SUMMARY

Junior AI Application Developer with hands-on experience building LLM-powered tools with Python, FastAPI, vector search, evaluation workflows, and Docker. Strong on turning AI features into production-style components with logging, validation, and API integration. Seeking a role focused on practical AI products rather than research-only work.

TECHNICAL SKILLS

Languages: Python, SQL, TypeScript

AI & Data: LLM integration, RAG, embeddings, prompt engineering, evaluation, data preprocessing

Backend: FastAPI, Node.js, REST APIs

Frontend: React, Next.js

Databases: PostgreSQL, vector database / pgvector, Redis

DevOps & Cloud: Docker, GitHub Actions, AWS / Azure

Tooling: Git, Jupyter, Postman

EXPERIENCE

AI / Software Intern | Organisation Name | Month YYYY - Month YYYY

- Built [AI-assisted workflow / internal tool / chatbot] using [Python / FastAPI / vector search], supporting [team / users / use case].
- Implemented [prompt templates / retrieval pipeline / evaluation script / moderation layer], improving [answer quality / response consistency / reviewer time] by [X].
- Exposed model outputs through [API / UI integration], with logging, retry handling, and validation for more reliable production behaviour.
- Worked with [engineers / analysts / stakeholders] to define success criteria and test outputs against real user scenarios.

SELECTED PROJECTS

Project Name | Python, FastAPI, Vector DB, Docker

- Built a retrieval-augmented assistant for [domain], including [ingestion, chunking, retrieval, answer generation, citations].
- Added [evaluation set / guardrails / output schema / confidence checks], reducing [hallucinations / invalid responses / review time] by [X].
- Containerised and deployed the service, documenting setup, architecture, and known limitations.

Project Name | React, FastAPI, PostgreSQL

- Developed a user-facing interface for [AI workflow], allowing [upload / query / compare / review] actions.
- Designed [review pipeline / human-in-the-loop step / feedback loop] so model outputs could be corrected and reused.

EDUCATION

Bachelor / Master of [Degree]
Institution Name | City | Expected YYYY / YYYY

CERTIFICATIONS

Relevant AI / Cloud / Data certificate | YYYY

OPTIONAL

Referees available on request

Backend Junior bullet bank

Replace the bracketed placeholders with your own specifics and metrics.

- Developed [REST/gRPC] endpoints in [framework] for [business function], reducing [manual effort / latency / processing time] by [X].
- Designed [schema / migration / cache / job queue] in [database/tool], enabling [throughput / concurrency / reliability target].
- Wrote [unit / integration / contract] tests for [critical path], reducing regressions in [feature area].
- Containerised [service] with Docker and automated deployment via [CI/CD tool], shortening release time from [X] to [Y].
- Investigated [incident / bug / performance issue], identified [root cause], and implemented a fix that improved [metric].
- Collaborated with [frontend / mobile / product / QA] to define API contracts and deliver [feature] within [sprint / release].
- Added [authentication / validation / rate limiting / observability], improving [security / correctness / debugging speed].

Tailoring workflow and document variants

Keyword tailoring should be modular, not cosmetic. NZ/AU job-board and recruiter guidance repeatedly says to analyse the job description, identify repeated terms, insert those terms naturally, and tailor the summary, skills, work bullets, and achievements accordingly. It also explicitly warns against hidden-keyword tricks. The right approach is therefore a “master resume plus targeted versions” workflow rather than a single generic file. ³⁵

Job-ad to resume-module mapping

Job ad signal	Best module	What to change	Example rewrite
Specific stack names	Summary, Skills, latest Work/Project bullet	Move matching stack terms upward	“Built customer-facing React and TypeScript features...”

Job ad signal	Best module	What to change	Example rewrite
Backend/API emphasis	Work Experience first, then Skills	Increase API/database bullets; cut weaker frontend detail	"Developed REST APIs and PostgreSQL schema..."
Cloud/DevOps emphasis	Skills plus one evidence bullet	Add deployment, CI/CD, observability evidence	"Containerised service and automated deployment..."
AI/LLM emphasis	Summary, Projects, Work bullets	Add evaluation, retrieval, validation, deployment evidence	"Implemented RAG pipeline with evaluation set..."
Collaboration/communication	Achievement bullets, not adjectives	Show stakeholder count, cross-team work, outcome	"Worked with product and QA to deliver..."
Learning agility / adaptability	Work or Project achievement	Use example, not claims	"Learned [tool] and shipped [feature] within [time]..."

The logic in this table follows local keyword guidance and recruiter advice to demonstrate skills with evidence rather than label-dropping or buzzwords. ³⁶

A useful practical sequence is: extract repeated nouns and verbs from the job ad; map each to one resume module; then make sure every high-priority keyword appears next to proof. For example, if the ad says "REST APIs, AWS, CI/CD, stakeholder communication", those should appear not only in a Skills list but also in recent work/project bullets that demonstrate real use. Hays also recommends adding close synonyms for important keywords, which is helpful when titles differ across employers. ³⁷

ATS-friendly copy and portfolio copy

Dimension	ATS-friendly copy	Visually enhanced portfolio copy
Primary use	Job portals, recruiters, large employers, government, job boards	Direct outreach, interview follow-up, networking, small firms, personal website
Layout	Single column, strict text order	Still simple, but may use restrained section dividers and slightly richer whitespace
File type	DOCX safest; text-based PDF if allowed	PDF usually fine
Visual treatment	No icons, no tables, no photos, minimal colour	One modest accent colour acceptable; still avoid complex multi-column layouts
Content emphasis	Keyword alignment, clear headings, parser safety	Same core content, with slightly stronger project branding and links
Risk tolerance	Low	Moderate, but only after ATS concerns are handled

The portfolio copy should be an adaptation of the ATS copy, not a completely different story. In NZ/AU, the resume/CV is still the core application document, but a code portfolio and visible project evidence materially strengthen your candidacy in IT. ³⁸

For the portfolio variant, the best complement is a strong GitHub ³⁹ profile. Official guidance recommends a professional bio, a profile README, and 3–5 pinned projects chosen for relevance and range, ideally mixing projects you own with open-source contributions. That gives you a proof-of-work layer without forcing the resume itself to become visually overloaded. ⁴⁰

One final NZ/AU-specific caution: if a role is in government or another employer that asks for separate selection criteria, keep the resume modular and concise and answer the criteria separately. Do not try to turn the resume into a criteria-response document. ¹¹

Source list

Official and government guidance

- Official NZ career-service guidance from Tahatū Career Navigator ⁴¹ : CV purpose, tailoring, skills-focused vs work-focused CVs, simple formatting, no images, and referee guidance. ⁴²
- Official Australian employment-service guidance from Workforce Australia ⁴³ : confirms the resume as a core job-application document, although the main page was JavaScript-gated during retrieval. ⁴⁴
- Official Australian guidance from Queensland Government ⁴⁵ : resume vs CV distinction, 1–3 page general guidance, required core modules, and note on separate selection criteria for some government roles. ¹¹
- Official Australian career guidance from myfuture ⁴⁶ : entry-level guidance aligning short/no-history candidates with chronological or skills-based structures. ⁴⁷
- Official Australian government resource from the Department of Employment and Workplace Relations ⁴⁸ : accessible resume examples resource. ⁴⁹

Major job boards

- SEEK ⁵⁰ NZ ATS guide: standard fonts, standard headings, .docx/.pdf file guidance, single-column rule, and tailoring instructions. ⁵¹
- SEEK AU ATS, summary, and length guidance: ATS-safe formatting, one-to-two-page expectation, one page for recent graduates, two lines per bullet, and summary length guidance. ⁵²
- Indeed ⁵³ Australia career guides: chronological/functional/combination structure, one-inch margin default, 10–12 pt font, ATS headings, and simple-format rules. NZ-specific public career-guide pages were not readily retrievable in this search, so the directly accessible Indeed source used here was Australia. ⁵⁴

Recruitment-firm guidance

- Hays ⁵⁵ NZ IT resume guide: IT-specific length, summary length, work section order, achievements, education, and references. ⁵⁶
- Hays Australia ATS and tech-CV guidance: CV parsing, keywords, accepted formats, soft-skill evidence, and the rule that technical skills listed should be hands-on and interview-defensible. ⁵⁷
- Robert Walters ⁵⁸ NZ and AU market guides: contact details at top, professional summary, reverse-chronological work history, relevant skills and projects, one-page expectation for recent graduates, and references usually on request. ⁵⁹

- Robert Walters NZ/AU technology guidance: tailoring, proofreading, online presence, and the importance of communication, adaptability, and problem-solving in technology hiring. ⁶⁰
- Michael Page ⁶¹ Australia guidance: result-first bullets, role-specific tailoring, the CV/resume geography distinction, and the value of proof-of-work in IT. ⁶²

Employer and platform guidance

- Employer-side software resume guidance from Stack Overflow ⁶³ : single-column scanning, relevance-first ordering, and stronger prioritisation of internships and meaningful project work over filler. ⁶⁴
- Official profile guidance from GitHub: profile README, best-project pinning, and portfolio proof-of-work that complements a resume rather than replacing it. ⁴⁰

¹ ⁶² <https://www.michaelpage.com.au/advice/career-advice/resume-and-cover-letter/how-write-winning-resume>

<https://www.michaelpage.com.au/advice/career-advice/resume-and-cover-letter/how-write-winning-resume>

² ³ ⁷ ⁸ ⁹ ¹⁰ ¹² ¹⁵ ²² ²³ ²⁹ ³⁰ ⁴² ⁵³ ⁵⁵ <https://tahatu.govt.nz/work/applying-for-a-job/how-to-write-a-cv>

<https://tahatu.govt.nz/work/applying-for-a-job/how-to-write-a-cv>

⁴ ¹³ ¹⁴ ¹⁷ ¹⁸ ²⁵ ³⁴ ³⁵ ³⁶ ⁴³ ⁵⁰ ⁵¹ <https://www.seek.co.nz/career-advice/article/tips-for-creating-an-ats-friendly-resume>

<https://www.seek.co.nz/career-advice/article/tips-for-creating-an-ats-friendly-resume>

⁵ ²⁴ ²⁷ ²⁸ ³³ ⁶⁴ <https://stackoverflow.blog/2020/11/25/how-to-write-an-effective-developer-resume-advice-from-a-hiring-manager/>

<https://stackoverflow.blog/2020/11/25/how-to-write-an-effective-developer-resume-advice-from-a-hiring-manager/>

⁶ ³⁸ ⁴¹ ⁴⁵ <https://www.michaelpage.com.au/advice/career-advice/resume-and-cover-letter/who-needs-cv-digital-future-recruitment>

<https://www.michaelpage.com.au/advice/career-advice/resume-and-cover-letter/who-needs-cv-digital-future-recruitment>

¹¹ <https://www.qld.gov.au/jobs/finding/resume>

<https://www.qld.gov.au/jobs/finding/resume>

¹⁶ <https://www.seek.com.au/career-advice/article/resume-summary>

<https://www.seek.com.au/career-advice/article/resume-summary>

¹⁹ ³⁹ <https://www.seek.com.au/career-advice/article/5-things-employers-wish-they-could-say-about-your-resume>

<https://www.seek.com.au/career-advice/article/5-things-employers-wish-they-could-say-about-your-resume>

²⁰ ³¹ ⁴⁶ <https://www.seek.com.au/career-advice/article/how-long-should-a-resume-be>

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